DATA ANALYST INTERNSHIP

Sales & Financial Performance Dashboard

Task 4 – Dashboard Design

An interactive business view using Power BI / Tableau concepts

Prepared using a sample sales-financial dataset (500 records)

Project Objective

What the dashboard is designed to help business stakeholders understand

- Monitor overall sales performance and profitability in one place.
- Compare sales across regions, product categories, products and sales channels.
- Track monthly sales movement and identify changes over time.
- Support business decisions with clear KPIs, filters and focused visualizations.

Dataset Overview

Sample sales-financial dataset used for this presentation

RECORDS	ORDERS	PRODUCTS	REGIONS
500	500	10	5

Key fields

- Order details: Order_ID, Order_Date, Region
- Product details: Product, Category, Units_Sold
- Sales details: Unit_Price, Gross_Sales, Discount, Net_Sales
- Financial details: Cost_of_Goods_Sold and Profit
- Business dimensions: Sales_Channel and Payment_Method

Executive KPI Summary

Headline measures calculated from the sample dataset

NET SALES

₹46,684,770

TOTAL PROFIT

₹9,826,244

PROFIT MARGIN

21.0%

AVERAGE ORDER VALUE

₹93,370

Units sold: 3,926 | Orders: 500

KPI formulas: Profit Margin = Total Profit ÷ Net Sales × 100; Average Order Value = Net Sales ÷ Number of Orders.

Proposed Dashboard Layout

Suggested one-page view for a sales manager

SALES PERFORMANCE OVERVIEW

Date ▼ | Region ▼ | Category ▼ | Channel ▼

NET SALES	PROFIT	MARGIN	ORDERS
₹46,684,770	₹9,826,244	21.0%	500

Monthly Sales Trend

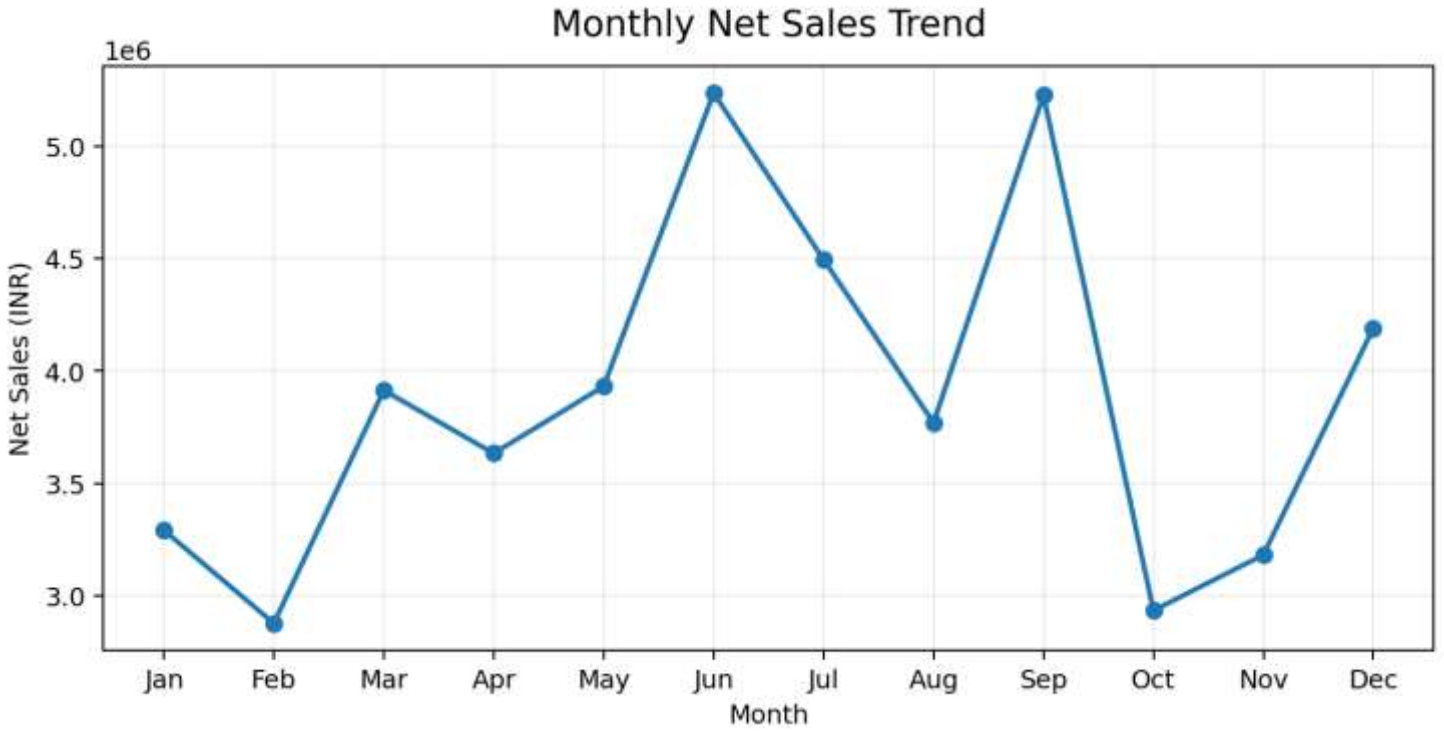
Sales by Region

Profit by Category

Filters → KPI cards → Trend and comparison charts → Business action

Time-Series Analysis

Monthly net sales help identify seasonality and changes in performance

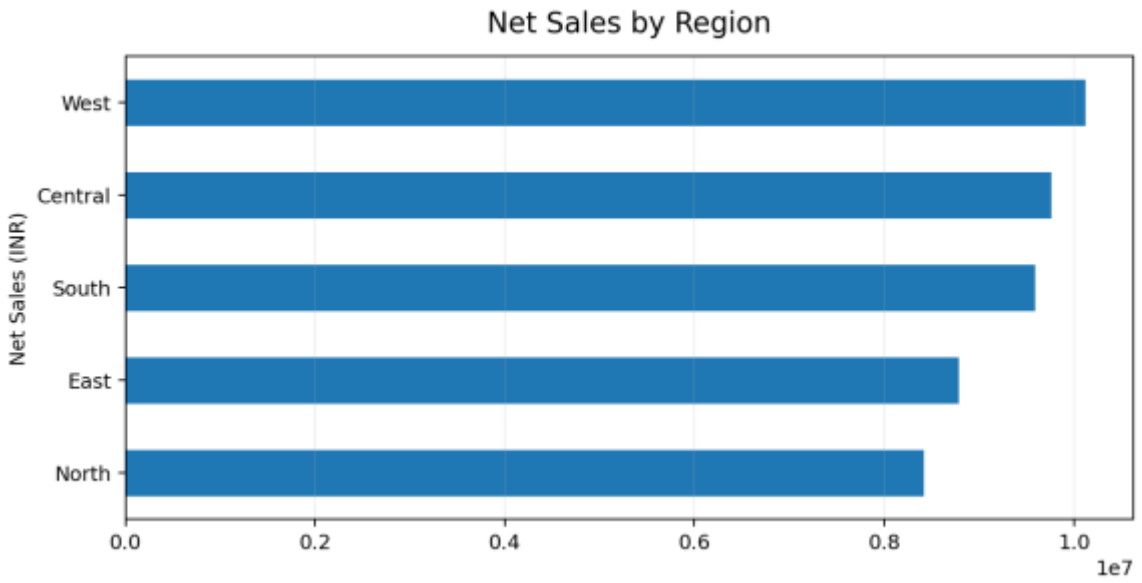


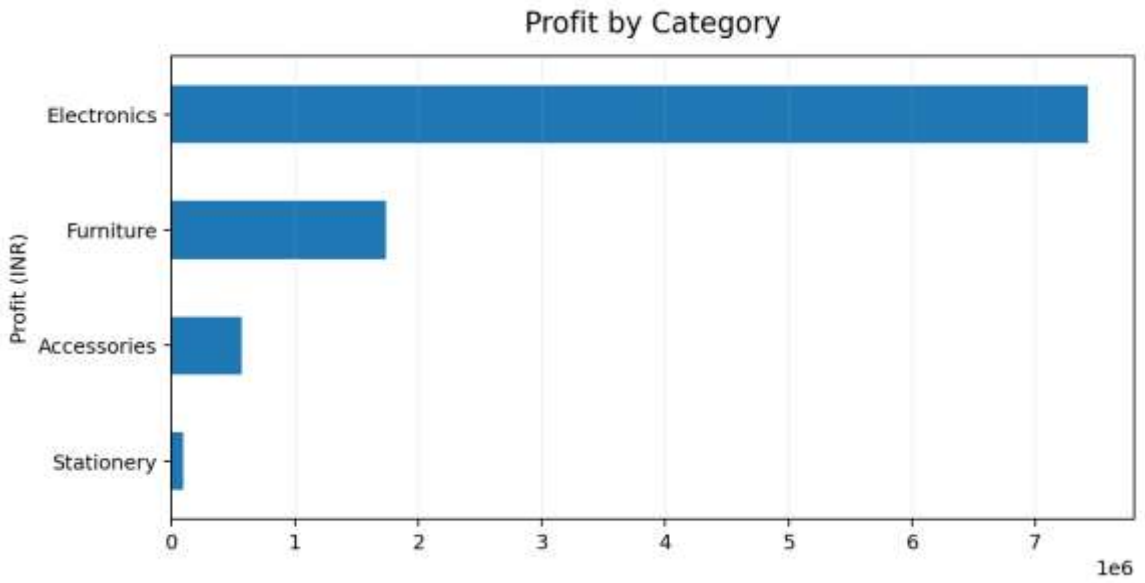
What to look for

- Highest sales month: June.
- Lowest sales month: February.
- Investigate sudden rises or falls before deciding on action.
- Compare the same months across years when more history is available.

Regional and Category Performance

Use comparisons to identify where sales and profit are concentrated



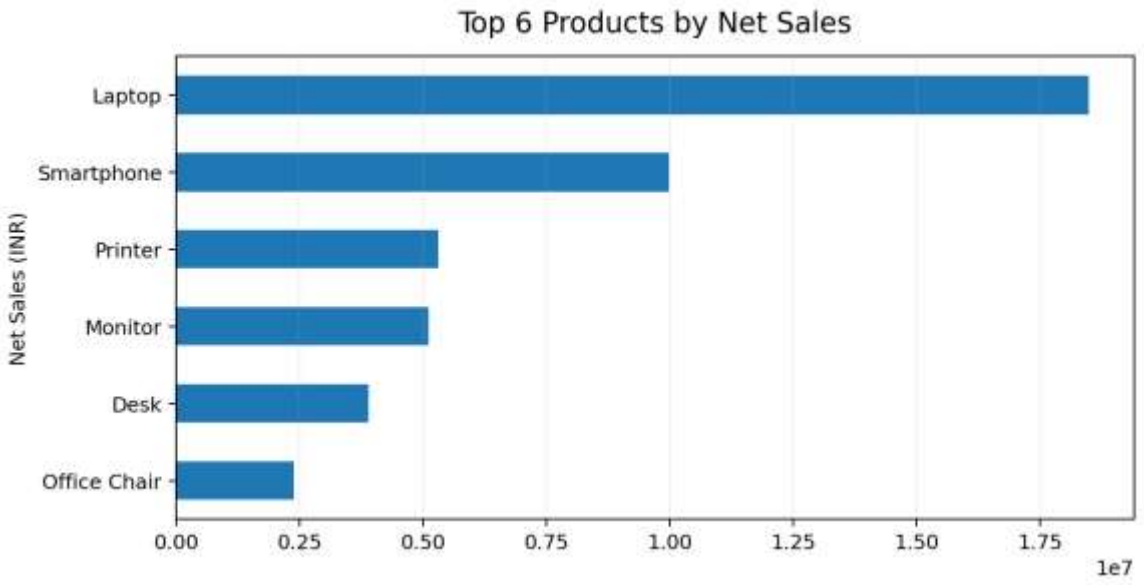


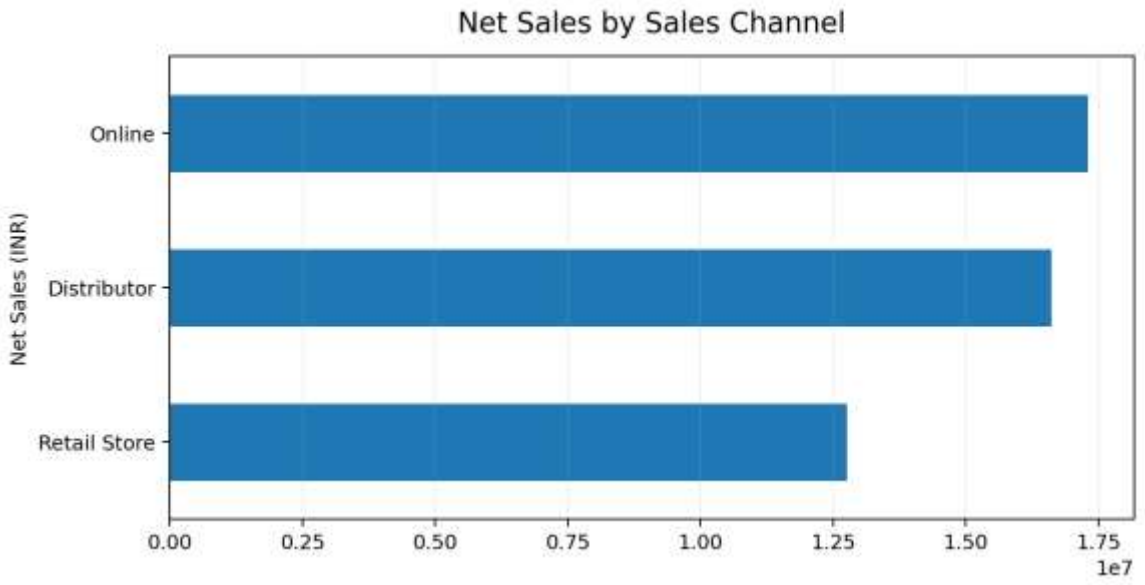
Top region by net sales: West (₹10,124,439)

Top category by profit: Electronics (₹7,426,900)

Product and Channel Analysis

Understand which products and routes to market contribute most





Top product: Laptop (₹18,485,500)

Leading channel: Online (₹17,304,788)

Interactivity and Navigation

How stakeholders can explore the information

- Slicers: filter by date, region, product category and sales channel.
- Cross-filtering: selecting a region or category updates related charts.
- Tooltips: show detailed sales, profit and order information on hover.
- Drill-down: move from category to product, or year to quarter and month.
- Navigation: use clear page buttons such as Overview, Region and Product Analysis.

Dashboard Design Best Practices

Keep the dashboard clear, consistent and decision-focused

- Choose KPIs that directly connect to business goals: Sales, Profit and Growth.
- Place summary cards at the top so key results are visible immediately.
- Use line charts for trends and bar charts for category comparisons.
- Apply a consistent colour theme and reserve highlight colours for important findings.
- Avoid clutter, unnecessary 3D effects and too many visuals on one page.
- Validate totals, date ranges and calculations before publishing.

Business Insights and Recommended Actions

Example findings generated from the sample dataset

- West is the leading region by net sales; review what is working there and test whether it can be replicated.
- Electronics contributes the highest total profit; protect availability and monitor its margin.
- Laptop is the top product by net sales; review inventory and demand before planning promotions.
- Online is the leading sales channel; compare its profitability and operating costs with other channels.
- Use monthly trends to plan stock, staffing and marketing activity around stronger and weaker periods.

Note: These are descriptive findings from a synthetic practice dataset, not audited company results.

Interview Questions – Quick Answers

Based on the Task 4 brief

What are the key elements of a dashboard?

KPIs, charts, filters/slicers, clear labels, consistent design and useful navigation.

What is a KPI?

A Key Performance Indicator is a measurable value used to track progress toward a business objective.

What are slicers in Power BI?

Slicers are on-screen filters that let users interactively narrow the data shown in a report.

Power BI vs Tableau?

Both are BI and visualization tools. Power BI integrates closely with Microsoft products; Tableau is known for flexible visual exploration.

How do you make a dashboard interactive?

Add slicers, cross-filtering, drill-down, tooltips and navigation buttons.

How do you handle large datasets?

Clean and model data, remove unused columns, use efficient relationships and measures, and apply appropriate aggregation.

Which charts are useful for trends?

Line charts are commonly used for trends over time; column charts can compare periods.

PROJECT SUMMARY

From raw sales data to business decisions

- Build the interactive dashboard in Power BI or Tableau.
- Include Sales, Profit and Growth KPIs, filters and time-series analysis.
- Add dashboard screenshots and this PPT to the project repository.
- Include the dataset and a short README.md explaining the work.

Thank you